

You Li (Leo)

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EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin-Madison

Bachelor's of Science, Computer Science

- GPA: 3.89

Madison, WI

Expected Graduation: December 2026

WORK EXPERIENCE

AI Research Intern

University of Wisconsin-Madison, Department of Computer Sciences

Madison, WI

September 2023 – Present

- Built a Python data pipeline to curate high-quality human debate samples for training LLM agents to simulate opinions across demographic groups, enabling research on AI agents as proxies for human participants
- Fine-tuned and evaluated LLMs using Supervised Fine-Tuning (SFT) and Direct Preference Optimization (DPO), achieving 78% embedding-based semantic similarity with human responses
- Parallelized LLM simulation pipelines using Python multiprocessing, reducing experiment runtime from 3 days to 12 hours (6× speedup)

Software Engineer Intern

Intelligible AI

Madison, WI

May 2026 – August 2026

- Implemented semantic search for 500+ users using Cohere Embed v4, Cohere Rerank 3.5, and Amazon OpenSearch Serverless vector search
- Built an automated dataset provisioning workflow with Next.js, AWS Lambda, and DynamoDB, improving product onboarding for 3 enterprise clients representing about \$60,000 in revenue
- Built a polling-based notification system using FastAPI, React, and PostgreSQL to surface completion updates for long-running asynchronous jobs

Software Engineer Intern

MDAQ-Global

Singapore

September 2024 – February 2025

- Developed REST APIs with Django and PostgreSQL for an internal software lifecycle management platform, reducing manual engineering effort through workflow automation
- Implemented document and image uploads using AWS S3 and Terraform, reducing manual artifact handling for DevOps and infrastructure teams
- Migrated automation workflows to asynchronous background processing using Celery and AWS SQS, eliminating ~7-second blocking waits and making user interactions effectively instantaneous

AI Engineer Intern

KLASS Engineering and Solutions

Singapore

May 2023 – August 2023

- Trained and evaluated EfficientPS, YOSO, and Mask2Former using PyTorch and NumPy for scene recognition on autonomous patrol robots
- Containerized and deployed computer vision models to Jueying X20 robots using Docker, enabling autonomous city-street deployment projected to save \$300K annually in labor costs

AI Research Intern

Agency for Science, Technology and Research (A*STAR)

Singapore

January 2022 – September 2022

- Developed a full-stack experimental platform using JavaScript, Flask, and SQLite that supported psychological studies with 500+ participants
- Trained and evaluated ResNet18, VGG16, AlexNet, and Vision Transformer models across novel-object and image-transformation datasets

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Singh, P.; Li, Y.; Sikarwar, A.; Lei, W.; Gao, D.; Talbot, M.B.; Sun, Y.; Shou, M.Z.; Kreiman, G.; Zhang, M.; “Learning to Learn: How to Continuously Teach Humans and Machines”, International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV), 2023. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2211.15470>
- Chuang, Y.; Tu, R.*; Dai, C.*; Li Y.* et al; “DEBATE: A Large-Scale Benchmark for Evaluating Opinion Dynamics in Role-Playing LLM Agents.”, Under Review. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2510.25110>
(*authors with core contributions)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, SQL

Frameworks: Next.js, React, Django, FastAPI, PyTorch

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS Lambda, DynamoDB, OpenSearch, S3, SQS, Docker, Terraform

Databases: PostgreSQL

Developer Tools: Git, Linux